Erasmus+ Poetry Programme

Interactive Digital Lesson Plan | October 2026

European Poets and Poems · Session 1: Novalis · Hymns to the Night



Artistic illustration

Adapted from the original “Short Lectures on Poetry” by Panagiota Laskari, philologist and poet. This version preserves the intercultural poetry focus while adding purposeful digital collaboration.

Learning objectives

Students will interpret poetic symbols, listen to poetry in German and Greek, exchange perspectives across languages, and co-create a short digital response. The emphasis is on learning through interaction, rather than on technology for its own sake.

Duration: 50 minutes | Languages: German / Greek for the poem; English for cross-group exchange | Grouping: mixed-nationality teams (3–4 students).

Lesson sequence

1. Opening: Our associations with “night” · 5 min

Digital tool: Padlet — “Before reading” column

- Prompt: “What is the first word or feeling you associate with NIGHT?” Students post one word in any language to the Padlet board.
- Display the Padlet contributions. Ask: “Which words are shared across cultures? Which are surprising?” Invite two brief explanations in English.

2. Meet Novalis: interactive mini-lecture · 8 min

Interactive approach: brief questions and a show of hands (no additional digital tool)

- Briefly introduce Novalis (1772–1801), early German Romanticism, and the themes of longing, light, night and dreams. Explain the background to Hymns to the Night without turning the session into a long biography.
- Pause twice: “Can darkness represent something positive?” (yes/no/not sure); “Can an old poem still describe our feelings today?” Students explain one choice.

3. Poetry across languages · 10 min

Digital tool: Padlet

- Read the First Hymn to the Night aloud in German (student or teacher), followed by the existing Greek translation. Use the original handouts; do not upload copyrighted translation text to public platforms.
- After listening, each student posts ONE feeling or symbol on a Padlet column called “First impressions”. Students may write in their home language and add a brief English explanation.

4. Intercultural interpretation · 12 min

Digital tool: Padlet in mixed-nationality groups

- Create Padlet columns: “Night & light”, “A powerful image”, “Different perspectives”. Each group publishes one post with a jointly agreed interpretation and one difference of opinion.
- Guiding questions: “What might night and light symbolise?” “What image stays with you?” “Did the two readings lead to different emotions?”
- Groups read and leave one respectful question or comment on another group’s post.

5. A poem in our own voices · 10 min

Digital tool: Canva (or one slide / paper as a low-tech alternative)

- Each group creates ONE poetry card: an original 1–2-line response inspired by the poem, with a symbol or image and two languages if possible.
- One spokesperson presents the card in 30 seconds. Add the completed cards to the Padlet “Our creations” column only with appropriate permission.

6. Exit ticket: What did we learn? · 5 min

Digital tool: Padlet — “Exit reflections” column

- Ask three short questions: “One new idea I discovered…”, “One thing I learned from a student from another country…”, and “How connected did you feel during today’s activity?” (1–5).
- Teacher reviews the responses as formative feedback, not as a language accuracy test.

Before the lesson: teacher checklist

- Prepare one moderated Padlet board and share its QR code or joining link with students.
- Create Padlet columns: Before reading / First impressions / Night & light / A powerful image / Different perspectives / Our creations / Exit reflections.
- Prepare one Canva template (optional) and provide paper or a shared device for groups without accounts.
- Check Wi-Fi and school policies; avoid collecting full student names, photos or recordings without appropriate permission. Keep the board private to participants.
- Print or distribute the authorised German original and Greek translation, as in the original lesson. Agree on support for students who prefer not to discuss grief personally.

Evidence of learning & Erasmus+ value

Padlet posts reveal initial ideas, interpretations and intercultural dialogue; Canva poetry cards provide a co-created learning product; final Padlet reflections capture student feedback. The main outcome is meaningful interaction among learners from different countries.

Low-tech backup: paper notes can be collected and uploaded to Padlet by the teacher; groups can sketch their poetry cards on paper if devices are limited.

Note: Padlet and Canva activities are proposed additions to the original source lesson. The teacher should create the board and optional Canva template before the session.